

2e. Prior learning and progression

The specification builds on the knowledge, understanding and skills established in GCSE English and in the National Curriculum Programmes of Study for Key Stage 4. It is expected that learners for A Level English Language will have studied English Language at GCSE level or equivalent.

Throughout the course of study learners are encouraged to develop a critical awareness of the structure of English and the ways in which the language is used, and to become confident and skilled in using English accurately and creatively.

This specification therefore provides a suitable foundation for the study of English Language, linguistics, or related courses in Higher Education. Equally it is also suitable for learners of various ages and backgrounds as part of a course of general education and lifelong learning.

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